

Delhi

The vroom boomers

No stunts, no speeding, no slobs.

These bikers by night are upstanding taxpaying citizens by day.

■ By Chitra Subramanyam

Tall, burly and clean-shaven, 16 men in black T-shirts and blue jeans cluster around a table and a round chocolate cake. They are the Thugs (Thunderbird Underground Slickers), celebrating their club's first anniversary at a café in south Delhi. "Happy birthday to us," they roar, as one of them cuts the cake into neat triangles. The pieces, atop tiny white plates with paper napkins, vanish in quick succession. They down their coffees and shakes, sitting on the steps outside, ready to kick-start their motorcycles, eager to hit the road.

It's just an average Sunday evening on the city's roads swarming with vehicles, buses and cyclists jostling for space, grabbing every inch of the road, jumping lanes and blaring horns. A distant roar threatens to overwhelm the familiar, drawing closer every minute. Climbing the flyover and hitting the road, merging into traffic, the bikers, astride Royal Enfield Thunderbirds,

cruise in perfect formation. They ride at a constant speed in rows of two, in harmony. An errant Maruti overtakes them, for a moment breaking their formation. But they are polite. And they follow the rules. No tricks, no swerving, no speeding and yes, helmets are a must.

The city's roads annoy them. It's here that they find themselves labelled in an instant and clubbed with beer-toting road hogs and romeos who think it's cool to weave through traffic and are blasé with rules. Nothing could be farther from the truth. The members are all professionals working as entrepreneurs or lawyers, or in MNCs, says Kushagr Agarwal, president of the club. There's also a dentist, an architect and two law students. And it was the Thunderbird, priced at approximately Rs 93,000, that formed the bond.

A year ago, when Agarwal was trawling the online community Orkut, he came up with the idea of a club. He, along with Ashish Kalsi, or Jaxy as he's called, set up a group. "We only have one rule—you have to own a Thunderbird to be part of the group," he

33,000

ENFIELDS
WERE SOLD IN
INDIA LAST
YEAR

BANDHEEP SINGH

